

Last-Place Miners Test Rugged Arizona

By **MARK LEIBSON**
Times Sports Writer

TEMPE, Ariz. — The University of Texas at El Paso has already had its baptism into Western Athletic Conference and now, according to baseball Coach Andy Cohen, the Miners are ready to play ball.

Last weekend in Tucson, UTEP dropped a three-game series to the defending NCAA champion Arizona Wildcats. The Miners again find themselves in the WAC's Southern Division cellar with an 0-3 record behind Arizona (3-0), New Mexico (2-1) and Arizona State (1-2).

"I know we can do a lot better than we did last weekend," said Cohen of the upcoming series here against Arizona State beginning with a single game at 7 p.m. in Packard Stadium followed by a Saturday doubleheader.

"The boys were somewhat awed by the Arizona team last week but now that we've had our baptism into conference play, I think you'll see us playing better ball.

"We had a complete letdown against Arizona. Our fielding wasn't good and our pitching, which had been our strong point all season long, broke down.

"Dave Jannusch had a hard time getting anybody out the first time he pitched against Arizona but he came back the next day and did a hell of a job".

Jannusch, 3-3 for the season, will start Friday's game against ASU's Larry Eiler, who has won six games without a defeat and owns the club's best earned run average at 1.74. Jannusch has allowed 6.42 runs per outing.

In past years, UTEP's success against Arizona State can be counted on one hand. In 51 meetings between the two WAC schools, the Sun Devils have won 46 while UTEP only five. ASU has taken the last 17 games from the Miners and 31 of the last 32.

Pacing UTEP's hitting attack is centerfielder Bob Alsup with a .430 average and nine stolen bases to lead the team. The lefthander has also done spot relief pitching and has the lowest ERA on the club at 4.32.

Freshman shortstop Rusty Kennedy follows Alsup with a .427 average while Keith Dwinell paces the team in runs batted in with 29 while averaging .366 during UTEP's first 34 games, 21 of which the Miners won.

Outfielder Ed Irvine is the leading hitter for the Sun Devils with a .412 average. Jim Horner is the team's home run king with 12, two more than all of the Miner homers put together.

Following the trip to Tempe, the Miners will return to El Paso, where they'll play their next nine WAC games at Dudley Field.

HARRY'S DISCOUNT